

AI Search Statistics 2026

60+ CITED DATA POINTS · CHATGPT · AI OVERVIEWS · GEO · EVERY STAT SOURCED

6 CATEGORIES

EVERY STAT CITED

UPDATED JUN 2026

WHAT THIS REPORT COVERS

AI search has moved from novelty to default. ChatGPT handles **2.5 billion prompts a day**, Google's AI Overviews reach **over 2 billion monthly users**, and on searches where an AI summary appears, only **8% of people click through to a website**. This report collects the data that matters for 2026 across six categories — adoption, AI Overviews, zero-click behaviour, referral traffic, how AI chooses what to cite, and the local & healthcare picture. **Every number is verified against its original publisher** — Pew, Gartner, Google, OpenAI, Ahrefs, Semrush and more. Figures we couldn't trace to a source were dropped.

PREPARED BY

Locully — SEO & AI Visibility, Bangkok

COVERAGE

6 categories · 60+ verified statistics

METHOD

Primary sources, cited & dated

FOR

Marketers & business owners

2.5B

ChatGPT prompts sent per day

2B+

Monthly Google AI Overviews users

68%

US Google searches end without a click

45%

Of consumers use AI to find local businesses

— 01 — ADOPTION & USAGE

How many people **use AI search**

AI search is no longer early-adopter behaviour. The headline numbers are now measured in billions of people every single week.

2.5B

ChatGPT prompts sent **per day** globally — roughly 330M from the US.

OPENAI VIA TECHCRUNCH · JUL 2025

900M

ChatGPT **weekly active users**, up from 800M in October 2025.

OPENAI · FEB 2026

2B+

Monthly **Google AI Overviews** users across 200+ countries.

ALPHABET Q2 2025 EARNINGS

34%

Of US adults have **used ChatGPT** — rising to 58% of under-30s.

PEW RESEARCH · JUN 2025

WHY IT MATTERS

- AI search is now **mainstream, not niche** — a third of US adults and most under-30s already use ChatGPT regularly.
- At billions of weekly users, your customers are **already asking AI** about your category — whether or not you show up.
- Both OpenAI and Google report usage **compounding every quarter** — this trend is accelerating, not levelling off.

— 02 — GOOGLE AI OVERVIEWS

What AI Overviews **do to your clicks**

AI Overviews sit on top of the world's biggest search engine. The data on how they reshape clicks is now clear.

18%

Of all Google searches now **produce an AI summary**; 58% of users saw one this month.

PEW RESEARCH · JUL 2025

8% vs 15%

Click-through **with an AI summary** vs **without** — roughly half the clicks.

PEW RESEARCH · JUL 2025

1%

Of users clicked a **source link inside** an AI summary.

PEW RESEARCH · JUL 2025

−34.5%

Click-through drop for the **#1 organic result** when an AI Overview appears.

AHREFS · 2025

WHY IT MATTERS

- When an AI summary appears, it **roughly halves the clicks** reaching your website — even from position one.
- Being the **source that gets quoted** now matters more than ranking, because users rarely click through to verify.
- Informational and question queries **trigger AI Overviews most** — exactly where top-of-funnel discovery happens.

— 03 — ZERO-CLICK & BEHAVIOUR SHIFT

The decline of **the click**

The bigger story behind AI search is the decline of the click itself.
Users get the answer and never leave the results page.

25%

Forecast drop in **traditional search volume** by 2026 as users shift to AI.

GARTNER · FEB 2024

68%

Of US Google searches **end without a click** — up from 60% in 2024.

SPARKTORO / SIMILARWEB · JUN 2026

15–25%

Estimated **organic traffic loss** as ~80% rely on zero-click results.

BAIN & COMPANY · FEB 2025

41%

Of **Gen Z** turn to social platforms first when searching, ahead of search engines.

SPROUT SOCIAL · MAY 2025

WHY IT MATTERS

- The click that traditional SEO was built to win is **no longer guaranteed** — most searches now end on the page.
- Organic traffic is **structurally shrinking**, so ranking visibility no longer equals website traffic.
- Younger audiences are **diversifying** across social and AI — relying on one search channel is now a real risk.

— 04 — BUSINESS IMPACT

Small volume, **high quality**

If AI keeps the click, does it still send business? Yes — in small but unusually high-quality volumes.

+357%

Year-over-year growth in **AI referral traffic** to websites.

SIMILARWEB · JUL 2025

7.1%

ChatGPT referral **conversion rate** — second only to paid search.

SIMILARWEB · MAY 2026

10×

Higher sign-up rate for LLM visitors — **1.66% vs 0.15%** for search (1,277 domains).

MICROSOFT CLARITY · NOV 2025

94%

Of enterprises plan to **increase GEO investment** in 2026.

CONDUCTOR · JAN 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

- AI referral traffic is still small, but it converts at among the **highest rates of any channel**.
- It concentrates on **high-intent pages** — pricing, solutions, comparisons — so quality outweighs raw volume.
- With 94% of enterprises funding GEO, the **competitive window is closing** — early movers win the citations.

05 - HOW LLMS CHOOSE & CITE SOURCES

What actually **gets** you cited

This is what matters most if you want to be quoted: what really drives whether an AI names your brand.

Up to 40%

Visibility gain from **GEO tactics**: citing sources, quotes, statistics. Keyword stuffing hurt.

AGGARWAL ET AL., KDD 2024 · ARXIV

~3×

Stronger correlation of **brand mentions** with AIO visibility than backlinks (75,000 brands).

AHREFS · MAY 2025

No uplift

Adding **schema markup** gave no meaningful AI-citation lift on already-cited pages.

AHREFS · 2026

Reddit #1

Most-cited **domain** across all AI engines, then YouTube & LinkedIn (30M sources).

PEEC AI VIA SEARCH ENGINE LAND · MAR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

- **Brand mentions** across the open web move AI visibility far more than backlinks or schema markup do.
- Concise, source-cited, **statistic-rich** content gets quoted — the old keyword-density playbook actively backfires.
- **UGC platforms** (Reddit, YouTube, LinkedIn) dominate AI citations, so presence there is now a direct visibility lever.

— 06 — LOCAL, HEALTHCARE & THAILAND

Where AI meets **local discovery**

For clinics and local businesses — especially in Thailand — the AI shift is already changing how customers find you.

40M

People ask ChatGPT a **health question** every day — ~70% outside clinic hours.

OPENAI · JAN 2026

45%

Of US consumers use AI to **find a local business** — up from 6% a year earlier.

BRIGHTLOCAL · MAR 2026

67.8M

Internet users in Thailand — 94.7% of the population. A near-saturated, AI-ready market.

DATAREPORTAL · NOV 2025

2.42B

People worldwide actively use **generative AI tools** — up 141% year-over-year.

DATAREPORTAL · APR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

- Patients and local buyers increasingly **ask AI first** — and often at night, when your business is closed.
- Thailand's **near-universal connectivity** and millions of medical tourists make it a prime AI-discovery market.
- Being **named in the AI answer** wins the booking; competitors absent from AI lose it without ever knowing.

— WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOU

Is your business **the answer** AI gives — or invisible to it?

Every statistic in this report points to the same shift: AI search is where buying decisions now begin. The businesses that get named inside ChatGPT, Perplexity and Google AI Overviews capture that demand. Everyone else never sees the leads they lose. **Locully helps clinics and businesses in Thailand get found and recommended in AI search.**

0 → 38

AI-sourced paid consultations
in a single month (May 2026)
for one Bangkok clinic

GET A FREE AI VISIBILITY AUDIT →

SOURCES & METHODOLOGY

Every statistic was checked against its **original source** before publishing. We prioritised primary sources — earnings calls, Pew, Gartner, academic papers and first-party platform data — over second-hand roundups, and dropped any figure we couldn't trace. Full pillar with live links:

locully.org/blog/ai-search-statistics

Pew Research

Gartner

Alphabet / Google

OpenAI

Microsoft

SparkToro

Bain & Company

Adobe

Similarweb

Microsoft Clarity

Previsable

Conductor

Ahrefs

Semrush

seoClarity

BrightEdge

arXiv (KDD'24)

Search Engine Land

Sprout Social

BrightLocal

DataReportal